

Login Page

Comparison between initial design and redesign

Initial Design

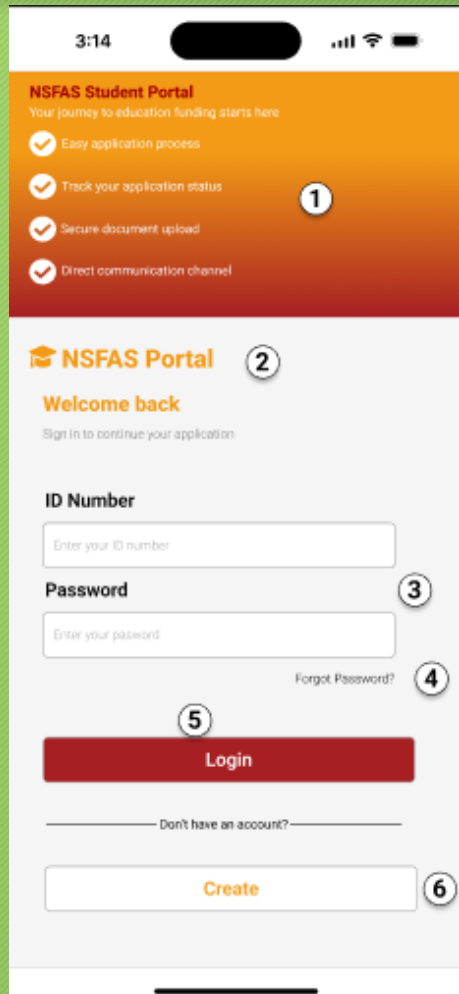
The screenshot shows the NSFAS Online application login interface. At the top is the NSFAS logo and the text 'NSFAS Online application'. Below this are three tabs: 'Login' (highlighted with a red underline and a circled '1'), 'Create Account', and 'Forgot Password'. A 'Welcome back' message (annotated with a circled '2') and the subtitle 'Your journey starts here, today' are displayed. The form contains an 'ID Number' input field (0/13 characters) and a 'Password' input field with a toggle icon. A red 'Login' button (annotated with a circled '3') is positioned below the fields. At the bottom, there is a link for users without a profile: 'Don't have a profile Get started by creating a profile'.

1.Visibility & Hierarchical Issue -The tabs are too cramped and cut off which reduces readability, this is a sign of poor visibility. There is also a hierarchical issue and this is caused by having no clear indication of which tab you are active on beyond a faint red underline.

2.Clarity issue - The text feels vague and is not informative, it adds unnecessary filler that is not guiding users.

3.Placement issue - The login button, while bold and having good contrast, is slightly cramped against the input fields, lacking breathing space and giving a hint to poor information architecture design and insufficient use of white spaces.

Redesign



1. Clarity, Motivation & Visual Hierarchy- This clearly highlights the benefits of the app instead of a vague text like on the initial design. This builds trust and motivation with the users.

2. Consistency- Clear branding is cleaner and more professional than the cut-off navigation of the old design.

3. Clarity, Spacing & alignments- Placeholder text gives clear instructions unlike the previous design and the input fields are well spaced out, improving readability and reducing cognitive load.

4. Consistency- It is placed correctly near the password field making it easier for the user to spot.

5. Hierarchy & Emphasis- The bold red login button stands out as the primary CTA (call-to-action).

6. Clarity & Hierarchy- We replaced the unprofessional “Don’t have a profile ” with a much cleaner “Don’t have a profile? Create”. We also improve the Hierarchy but making the secondary CTA visually distinctive from the main CTA.

Create Account

Comparison between initial design and redesign

Initial Design

NSFAS Online application

Login **Create Account** Forgot Password

Create profile
Get started by creating a new profile

First name(s) as seen on your ID document

Last name as seen on your ID document

ID Number

Are you married?
☐ No ☐ Yes

Are you disabled?
☐ No ☐ Yes

☐ I understand and accept the T&C's

Next

1. Clarity & Feedback issues - There is not visual indicator of which tab the user is busy on. The active tab should be clearly defined and should be distinctively highlighted.

2. Clarity & Error prevention - The “Select Province” and the “Select Race” are represented differently from the other input fields which could lead the user to think they aren’t important and that could lead to an error in the application.

3. Professionalism & Clarity - The text is shorted and uses an informal abbreviation. This appears unprofessional and could undermine the users trust in the application.

NSFAS Online application

Login **Create Account** Forgot Password

Create profile
Get started by creating a new profile

First name(s) as seen on your ID document

Last name as seen on your ID document

ID Number

Are you married?
☐ No ☐ Yes

Are you disabled?
☐ No ☐ Yes

☐ I understand and accept the T&C's

Next

Redesign

3:14

NSFAS Portal ①

Sign Up

Sign up to use your NSFAS journey

Your full name

Enter your full name

Email

Enter your email ②

ID Number

Enter your ID number

Phone number

Enter your phone number

Select Race

Select Race ▼

Select Province

Select Province ▼

Are you married? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Are you disabled? ☐ Yes ☐ No ③

☐ Do you understand and agree with the Terms and Conditions?

Create ④

< Back to login ⑤

1. Clarity & Hierarchy- The use of a clear title and section header establishes the pages purpose while the supporting text is simple creating an overall user focused design.

2. Consistency & Scannability- All form fields are consistently labelled with a clear and descriptive label which provides a consistent format that lowers the cognitive load.

3. Error prevention & Clarity- The Yes/No questions are consistent in the redesign which eliminates user confusion.

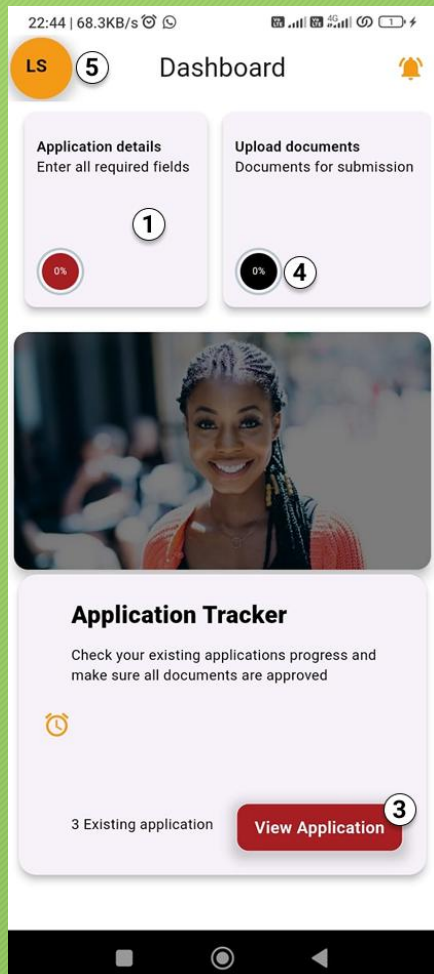
4. Hierarchy & Visibility- The primary action button is a simple but bold “Create”. Its placement follows the logical flow of the page and has a strong visual weight which makes it clear to the user what needs to do to complete the task

5. User control & Freedom- The “Back to login” button at the bottom provides a clear and easy exit for the user who landed on the wrong page.

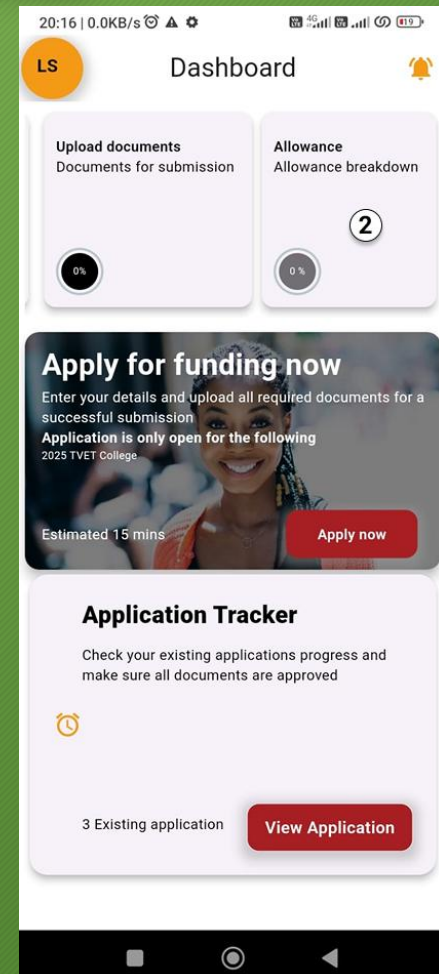
Dashboard pages

Comparison between initial design and redesign

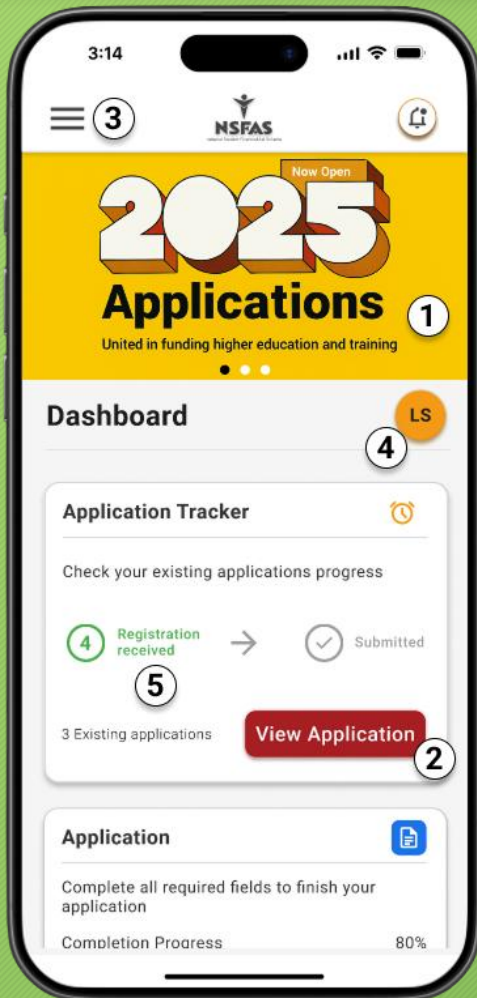
Initial Design



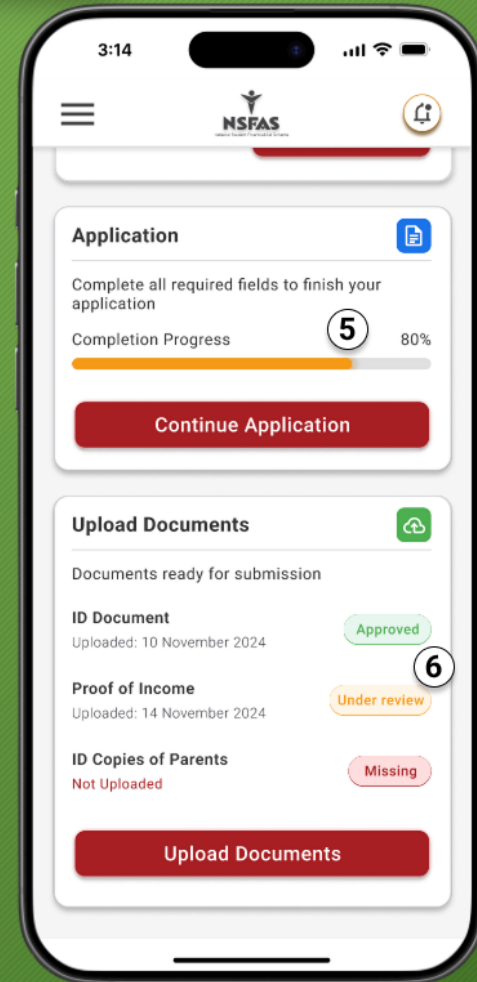
1. **None clickable cards:** the cards appear tappable but aren't. They don't lead to anywhere which makes users confused as to what their purpose is.
2. **Hidden allowance card:** users can only find this card if they accidentally scroll horizontally. There's no clear visual indication that there are any hidden cards, which robs users from discovering important information.
3. **Limited actions:** the only obvious tappable item is the "View Application" button, leaving other features hard to access.
4. **Unclear percentages:** Progress indicators are hard to understand, as the blocks are not clickable to access information leaving no explanation as to what 0% entails.
5. **Visual polish issues:** User initials are not centered in the orange block, and the oversized shadow cuts off at the edge, making the UI look unrefined.



Redesign



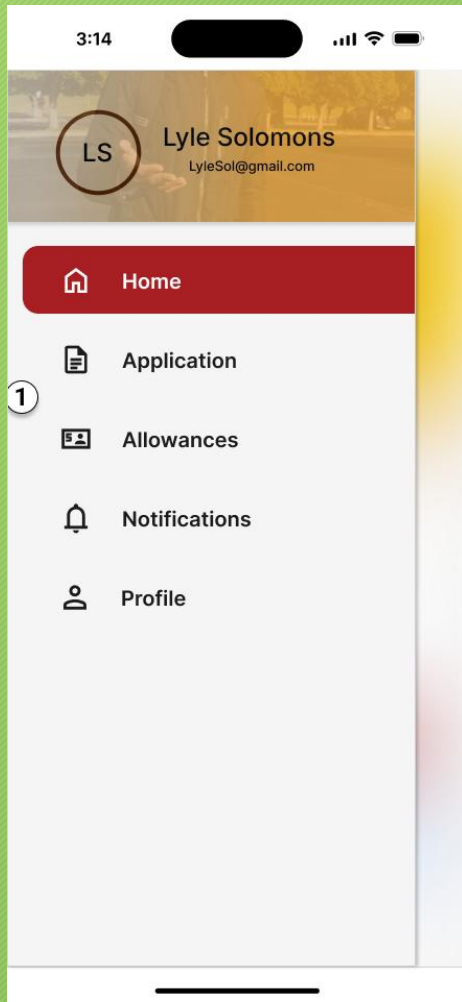
1. **Information carousel:** Displays important updates, which is designed in a way that captures a users attention upon startup.
2. **Red CTA buttons:** Each card now leads to its respective feature using red buttons which are used to guide users unlike in the original design where it had no functionality.
3. **Side menu burger bar:** It's a standard mobile UI pattern, which creates a sense of familiarity and ease of use to its users.
4. **Visual updates:** User initials are now centered in the orange block, and the shadow it reduced.
5. **Progress Indications:** Shows users their progress clearly with green for complete, and a progress bar to clearly indicate a user's progress which fixes the percentage confusions in the original design.
6. **Color indications:** In the document section, the colours indicate to the user what is required, making it easier to identify. Red for missing, green for approved and orange for pending or under review.



Menu-bar

Comparison between initial design and redesign

New design

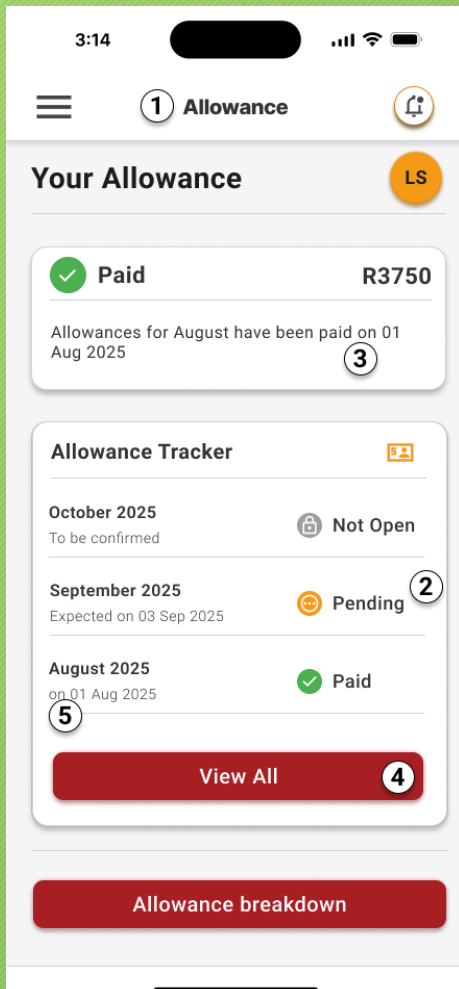


- 1. Visible menu-Items, Improved discoverability, Consistent layout:**
Home, Application, Allowances, Notifications, and Profile are all accessible without hiding any content. This makes discovering features easier without users needing to guess where features are. The design uses a predictable structure where users can easily identify which pages they are on by the red highlights, which in turn reduces confusion.

Allowances

Comparison between initial design and redesign

Redesign

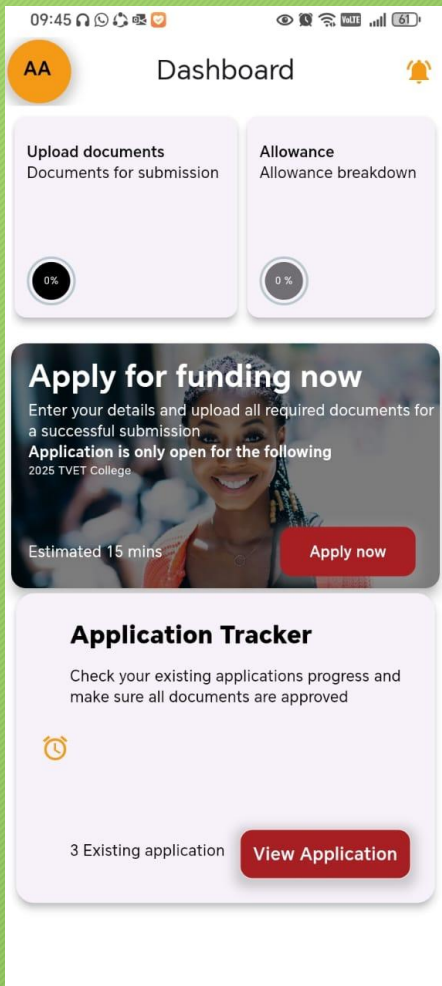


1. **Dedicated allowance section:** The allowances was moved to its own dedicated page, which fixed the hidden allowance issue and made the the home page focus mainly on applications.
2. **Colour sets:** Colour coded indicators where used to provide instant clarity to users
3. **Allowance summary:** Displays the current months status and amounts paid.
4. **View all button:** Allows users to view their complete year history. This is used to ensure that the screen is not overloaded and deduces clutter.
5. **Transparency:** Clear amounts, statuses and dates help build users trust.

Allowance Breakdown pages

Comparison between initial design and redesign

Initial design



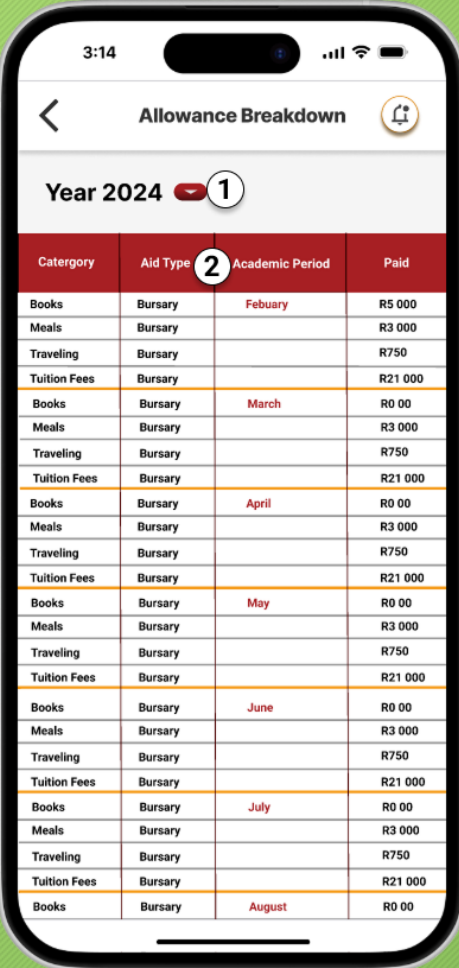
“Allowance Breakdown” Section

In the old design the allowance section is visually shown on the dashboard but it is non-interactive and gives no breakdown or detailed information when tapped.

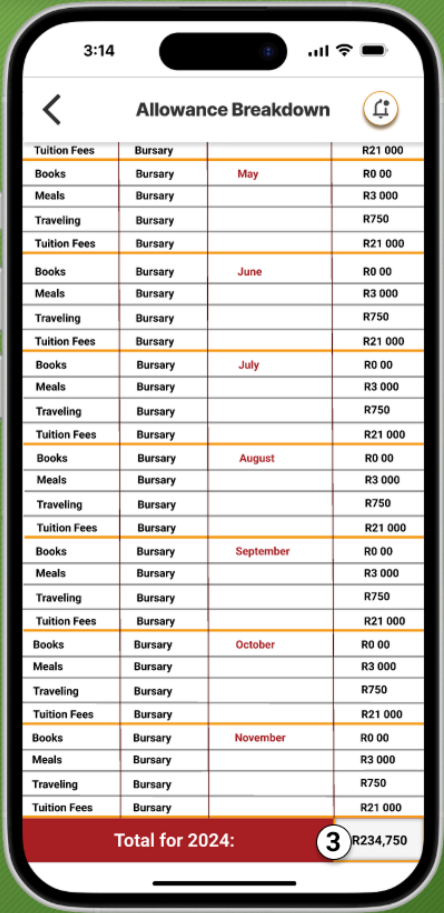
Issues:

- No tap response once clicked no data, no table and no detailed breakdown is shown.
- Users are unable to view how allowance received or what has been paid.
- This leads to unnecessary queries and confusion from users who wants to track their funds.

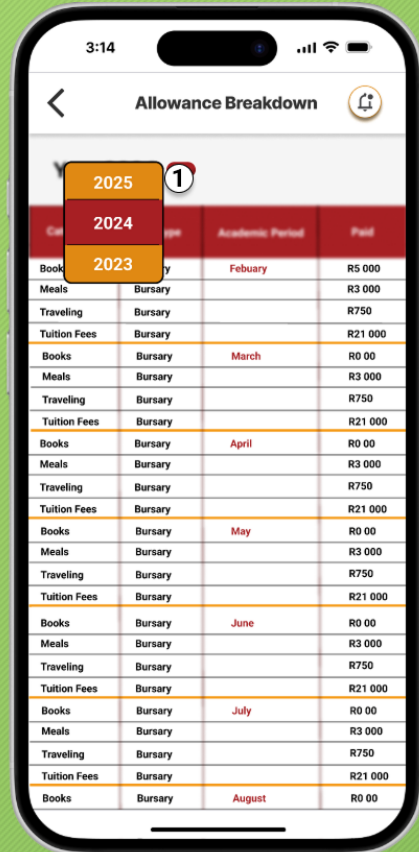
Redesign



- Year Selector:** This is a year selector that allows you to select a academic year to view the allowance breakdown for that specific year.
- Academic Period Column:** Shows the months when the allowances are scheduled to be paid. It helps keep track of bursary funds that are disbursed for Books, Meals, Traveling and Tuition fees.
- Total For 2024:** Shows the grand total for all payment amounts for the selected year. It adds up all the amounts from the paid column for every category and month.



New design

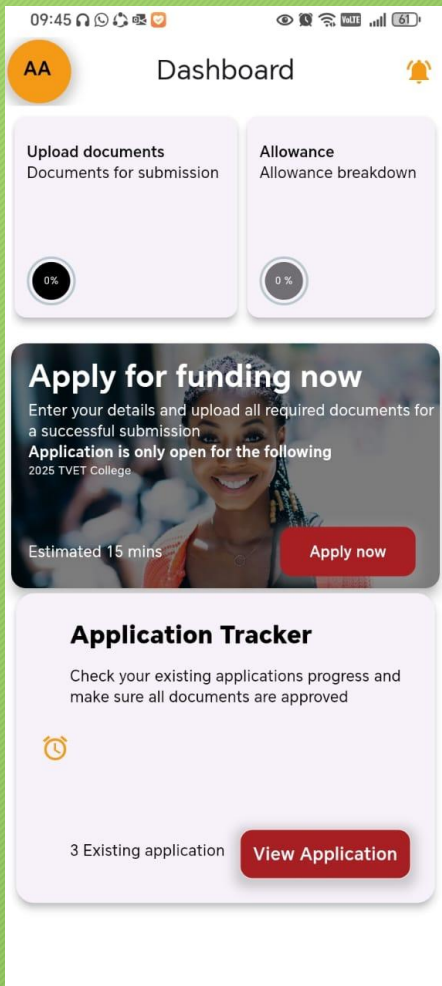


- 1. Year Dropdown Menu:** This allows you to switch between Academic years. When you select a year the breakdown updates and shows all payments for that year.

Upload documents

New design

Initial design



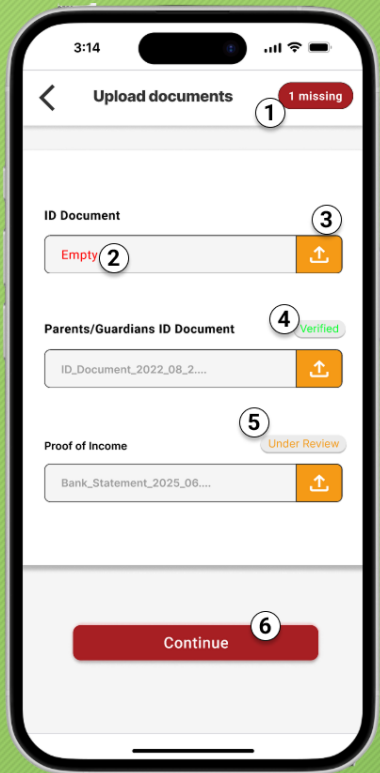
“Upload Documents” Section

In the old design the upload documents section that appears on the dashboard does not perform any action and is not linked to any a functional webpage.

Issues:

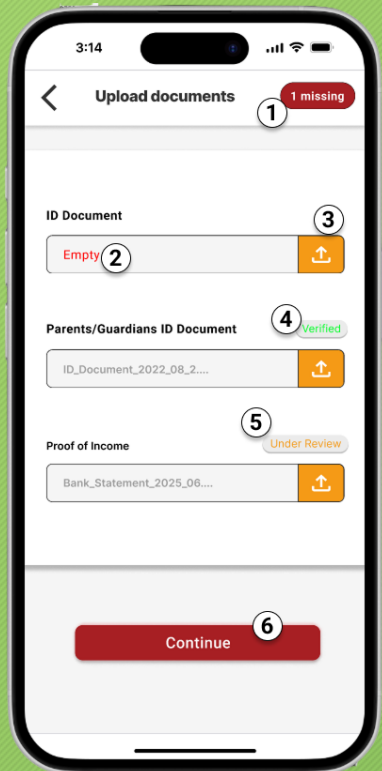
- Tapping does nothing which makes it appear broken.
- Users can not upload or check documents which can lead to frustration and delays.
- It gives us no actionable feedback as in the progress bar shows 0% but does not explain why and how to fix it.

New design



1. **“1 missing” Status indicator:** This Displays the number of documents still missing which allows users to identify incomplete sections resulting in reduced confusion and prevents submission errors.
2. **“Empty” field status in ID Document:** Indicates that the ID Document field is currently empty and needs to be uploaded. Used to draw attention to the users.
3. **Upload Button:** Allows users to upload their Documents. Placed next to each field to make easier to know where and how to upload each document.

New design

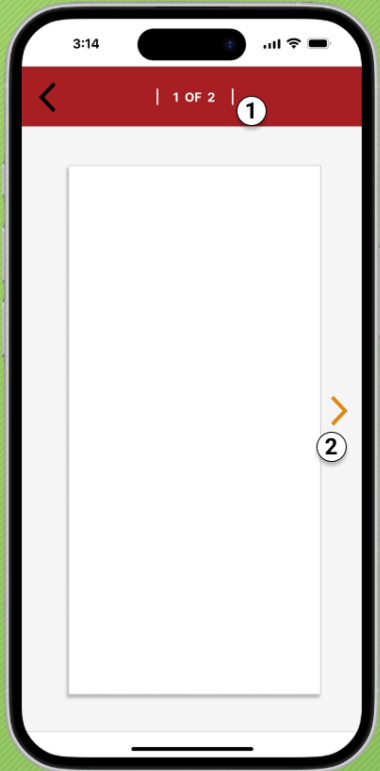


4. **”Verified” Status:** The Shows that the Document has been successfully verified. It reassures the users that the step is completed.

5. **“Under Review” Status:** Indicates that the uploaded document is still under the review process. This also shows that the document has been upload and not approved which means its still going through the verification process.

6. **Continue Button:** Prevents users from continuing unless all required documents have been uploaded.

New design

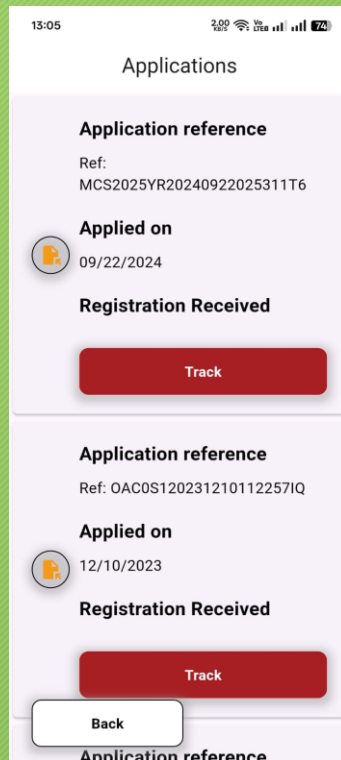


1. **Page Indicator:** .This shows the current page of the document preview. “1 of 2” indicated that there are 2 pages in total and that the user is viewing the first one. This Helps the users know how many pages they haveand prevents them from thinking something is missing.
2. **Next Arrow Page:** Tapping this arrow will allow the users to move to the next page of the document. We used arrows for page turns because of its familiar pattern to flippin pages in a book.

View Applications page

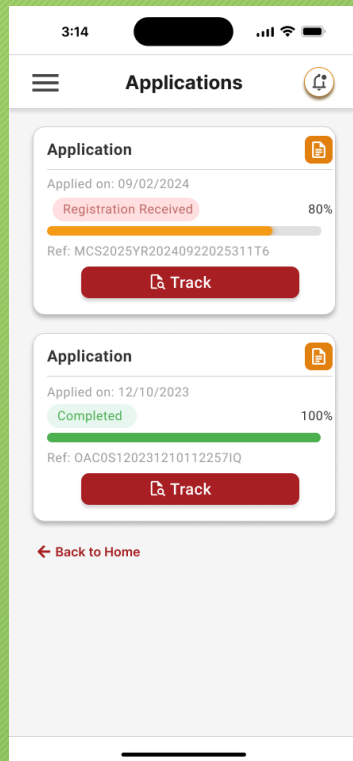
Comparison of the Applications, Tracker and Details for the Initial
and Redesign

Initial design



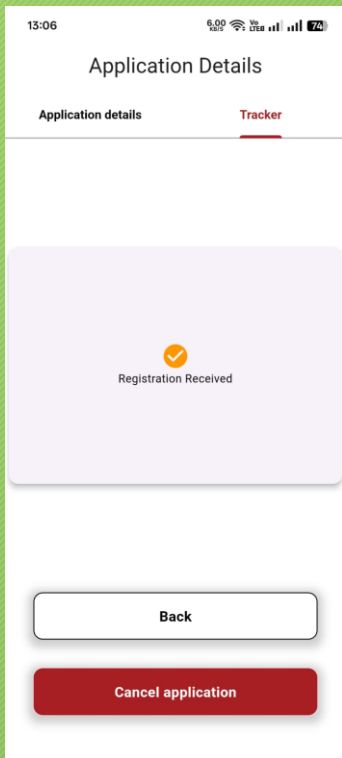
1. **Repetitive Layout** – Each application card looks the same, showing only reference, date, and status.
2. **No Progress Indicators** – Users can't see how far each application has progressed.
3. **Limited Feedback** – Status is text-only, no color or visual cues for quick recognition.
4. **Weak Navigation** – Only a Back button at the bottom, no quick link back to Home.
5. **Unpolished Visuals** – Cards feel flat and crowded, without proper spacing or hierarchy.

Redesign



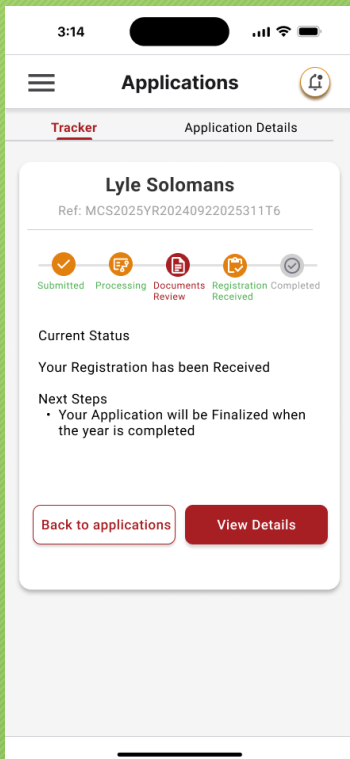
1. **Progress Feedback** - Each application includes a progress bar with percentage completion.
2. **Colour Coding** - Status uses clear colors (red = registration received, green = completed) for instant recognition.
3. **Cleaner Layout** - Information is grouped more clearly Applied on, Status, Reference.
4. **Improved Navigation** - Back to Home option provided; burger menu and notification icon add usability.
5. **Modern Look** - Balanced spacing, icons, and strong hierarchy create a professional, user-friendly design.

Initial design



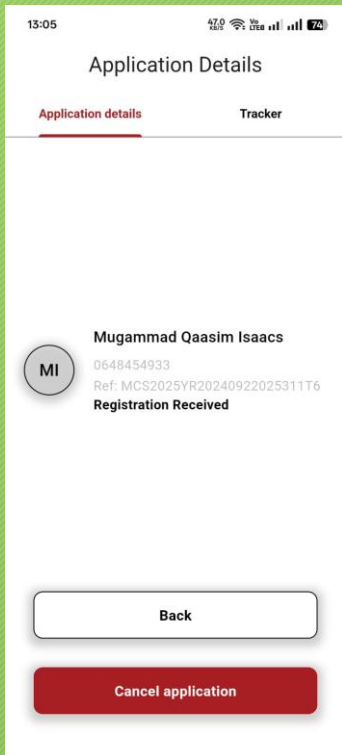
1. **Layout** - The structure is plain and does not guide the user, leaving the screen feeling empty and unfinished.
2. **Progress Tracking** - Users cannot clearly see where they are in the process, which creates uncertainty and frustration.
3. **Actions** - Very few interactive elements are available, so users struggle to know what they can actually do.
4. **Cancel Button** - The cancel action is too large and too visible, which risks users making mistakes or feeling anxious.
5. **Colours** - Colours are present but lack purpose; they do not communicate status or meaning effectively.

Redesign



1. **Layout** - A clear and structured design that organizes information in a way that is easy to scan and follow.
2. **Progress Tracking** - A step-by-step tracker shows users exactly where they are and what comes next.
3. **Actions** - Buttons are well placed and labeled, making it obvious what actions are available and reducing confusion.
4. **Colours** - Red, green, and orange are used consistently to show progress and status, making the experience intuitive.
5. **Overall Experience** - The flow feels polished, user-friendly, and trustworthy, giving users confidence in the process.

Initial design



1. Minimal layout - shows only essential information.
2. No card divisions - making the structure look very plain.
3. Colour - Mostly black, grey, and white with red only for tabs and cancel button.
4. Lack of progress bar - reduces clarity on application status.
5. Layout - Very simple but feels more polished and engaging.
6. Buttons - back and Cancel buttons are clear and functional.
7. Overall design - is straightforward but weaker than the first page.

Redesign

The mockup displays a mobile application interface for 'Applications'. At the top, a status bar shows the time 3:14 and signal strength. Below is a navigation bar with a hamburger menu, the title 'Applications', and a notification icon. A secondary bar contains 'Tracker' and 'Application Details' (the latter is highlighted in red). The main content area features a card for 'Lyle Solomons' with the following sections:

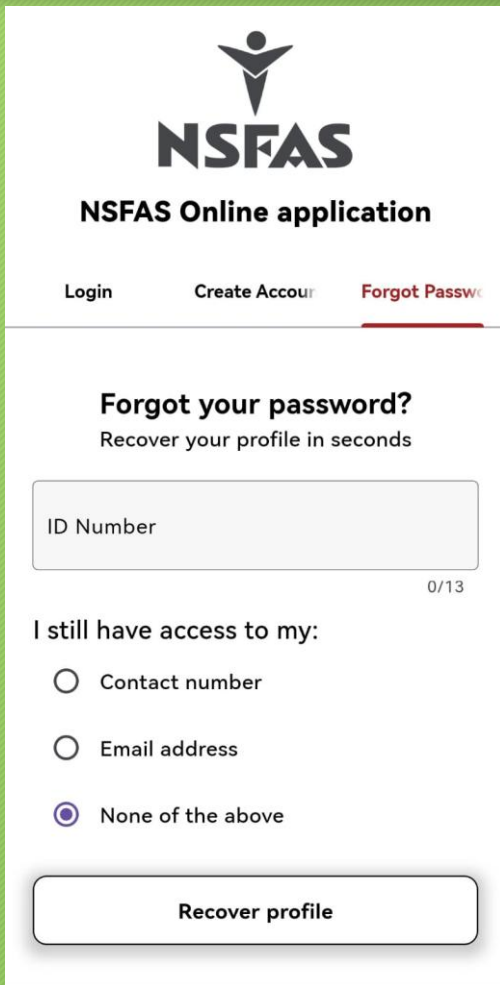
- Application Information:**
 - Reference Number: Ref: MCS2020YR20240922025311T6
 - Application Type: Bursary
 - Date Submitted: 09/22/2024
 - Current Status: Registration Received
- Personal Information:**
 - Full Name: Lyle Solomons
 - ID Number: 0203125112081
 - Phone Number: 0612553891
 - Email Address: Lyle02@gmail.com
- Application Progress:**
 - A progress bar showing approximately 80% completion.
 - Text: 'Your application is approximately 80% complete'
 - Buttons: 'View Tracking' (white with red border) and 'Cancel Application' (solid red).

1. Structured card layout - separates application and personal details.
2. Progress bar at the bottom - shows completion clearly.
3. Main highlight color - white used, grey cards with shadows give a modern feel.
4. Red buttons for key actions - stand out strongly.
5. Labeled fields - improve readability and clarity.
6. Progress indicator - adds transparency to the process.
7. Cancel and Tracking buttons - Indicates clearly the actions.
8. Overall design - looks professional, balanced, and polished.

Forgot Password Page

Comparison between initial design and redesign

Initial Design



The screenshot shows the NSFAS Online application interface. At the top is the NSFAS logo and the text "NSFAS Online application". Below this are links for "Login", "Create Account", and "Forgot Password". The "Forgot Password" link is underlined in red. The main heading is "Forgot your password?" with the subtext "Recover your profile in seconds". There is a text input field labeled "ID Number" with a character count "0/13" to its right. Below the input field, there is a section titled "I still have access to my:" with three radio button options: "Contact number", "Email address", and "None of the above". The "None of the above" option is selected. At the bottom is a button labeled "Recover profile".

- Strengths:

- Minimalism avoids clutter.

- Weaknesses:

- Over-simplified to the point of being **non-functional**.
- Missing **title/heading** (no context: users don't know it's a password recovery page).
- Missing the **core input field (ID number)** needed to complete the task.
- Radio button options lack context and purpose → causes **confusion**.
- No guidance or next steps for the user.

- Lesson:

Minimalism must balance simplicity with usability; removing essential elements breaks functionality.

Redesign

The image shows a mobile app interface for NSFAS. At the top, the status bar shows the time 3:14, signal strength, Wi-Fi, and battery. The app header is orange with the NSFAS logo. Below the header, there's a section titled "Forgot Your Password?" with a subtitle "Don't worry! Recover your NSFAS profile quickly and securely with our verification process." and four bullet points: "Secure account verification", "Quick recovery process", "Multiple recovery options", and "24/7 Support available". The main section is titled "Recover Your Password" and contains the instruction "Enter your details to verify your identity and reset your password". It features an "ID Number" input field with a South African ID card icon and a character count "0/13". Below this, there's a section "I still have access to my:" with three radio button options: "Contact number", "Email address", and "None of the above". At the bottom, there's a red "Recover Profile" button and a "Back to Login" link with a left arrow.

•Strengths:

- Clear title (“Forgot Your Password?”) establishes context.
- Reassuring text helps reduce anxiety and sets user expectations.
- Includes ID number input field with character count indicator (prevents input errors).
- Logical flow: identification → account selection → recovery process.
- Added navigation options (e.g., “Back to Login”).
- Support features build user trust.

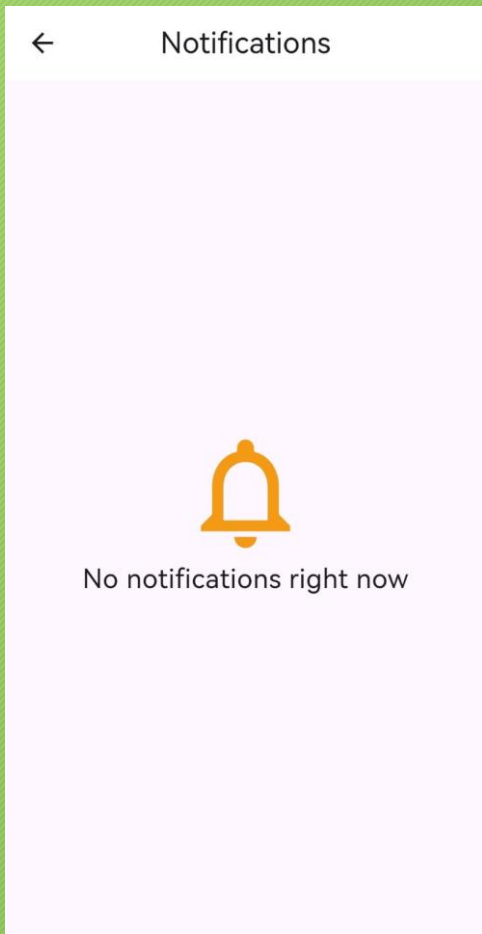
•Lesson:

Effective design should guide, reassure, and empower users through clarity, feedback, and support options.

Notifications Page

Comparison between the initial design and the redesign

Initial Design



- Strengths:**

- Works as a placeholder for an **empty state**.

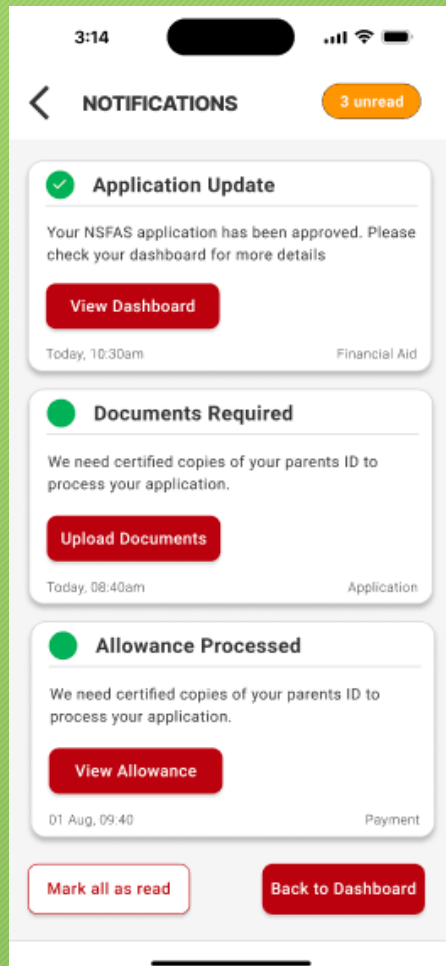
- Weaknesses:**

- Generic heading and passive message (“No notifications right now”).
- Provides **no guidance, timeline, or expectation-setting**.
- Creates **user anxiety** by showing inactivity without reassurance.
- Lacks any **functionality** beyond stating emptiness.

- Lesson:**

Empty states should still provide value, context, and reassurance instead of dead-ends.

Redesign



•Strengths:

- Transforms into an **interactive dashboard**.
- Notifications organized into **clear categories** (Financial Aid, Application, Payment).
- Each notification is a **card with timestamp** → improves clarity.
- Notifications are **actionable** (e.g., Upload Document, View Dashboard).
- Features like “Mark all as read” and “Back to Dashboard” enhance navigation and control.

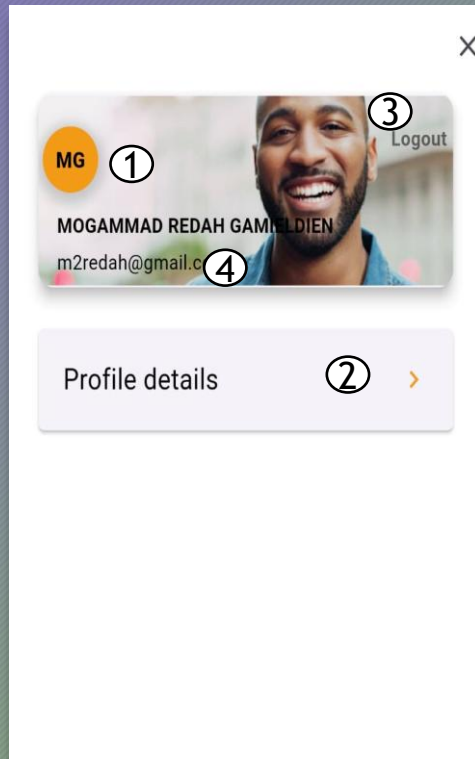
•Lesson:

A notification center should go beyond information display to support decision-making and task management.

Profile Page

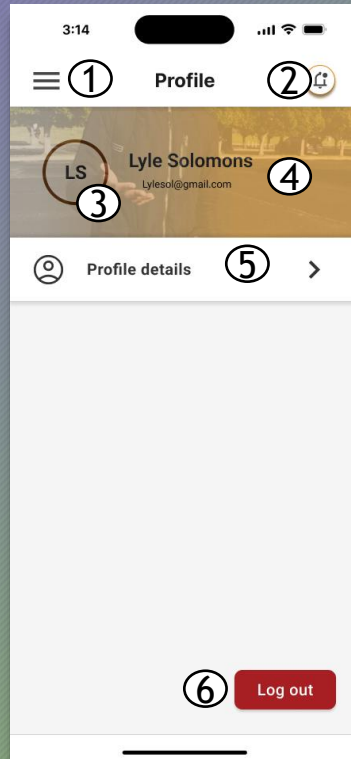
Comparison between the initial design and the redesign

Initial Design 1



1. A circle with your initials
2. “Profile details” with a arrow to indicate it will reveal something. Looks very basic a dull
3. A log out button. It is hardly noticeable in the corner
4. Your full name and email that you can barely see the full thing because of the background image.

Redesign 1



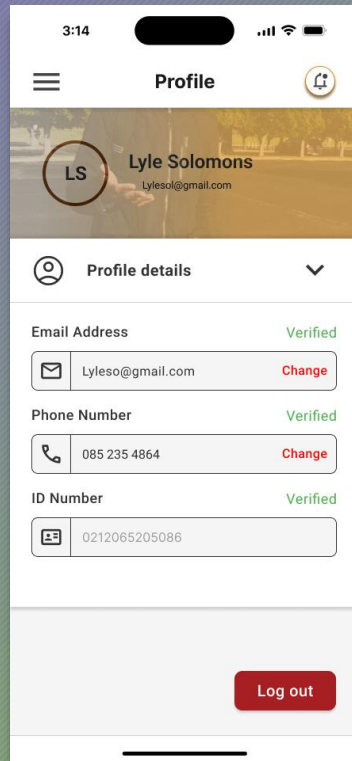
1. Able to navigate with the menu bar
2. Can check any notifications
3. Your initials in a circle
4. Name and email underneath each other, same as old design
5. “Profile details” with and icon that leads you to your details.
6. Log out button at the bottom and is noticeable

Initial design 2

The image shows a mobile app profile page titled "Profile". It features a circular profile picture with the initials "MG" (annotated with a circled 1). To the right of the picture is the full name "MOGAMMAD REDA" (annotated with a circled 2) and a small ID number "0308125105087". Below the name are two input fields: "Email address" containing "m2redah@gmail.com" (annotated with a circled 3) and "Cellphone number" containing "0744577130" (also annotated with a circled 3). Both fields have a green "Verified" status (annotated with a circled 4). At the bottom are two buttons: a white "Back" button (annotated with a circled 5) and a red "Save" button.

- Takes you to a completely different page after you click on “Profile details”.
1. Circle with initials in it
 2. Full name with a very unnoticeable ID number at the bottom of it.
 3. You have email and phone number headings looking out of place
 4. “Verified” not centered
 5. A back and save button to indicate that if you want to go back to profile or save any edited details

Redesign 2



- Instead of going to a new page the arrow and details scrolls down.
- Email address and Phone number in appropriate positions.
- Proper use of icons
- Change button to change any details
- Id number with its information greyed out to indicate it cannot be changed

Logout Button

Comparison between the initial design and the redesign

Initial design

NSFAS
NSFAS Online application

[Login](#) [Create Account](#) [Forgot Password](#)

Welcome back
Your journey starts here, today

ID Number

0/13

Password

Login

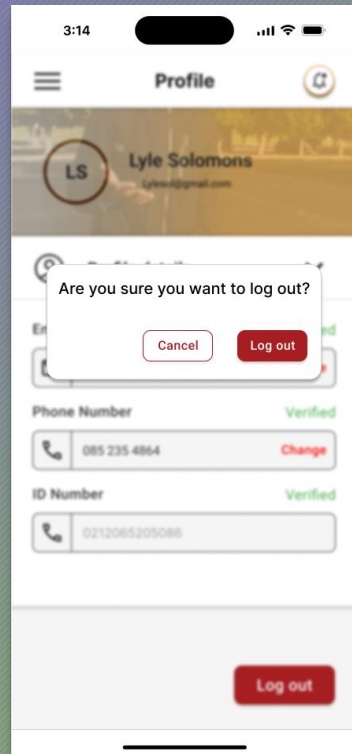
Or

Don't have an profile
Get started by creating an profile

Successfully logged out 1

1. When you press the logout button in profile you immediately log out.
- You are not giving a pop-up message to say if you sure you want to log out.

Redesign



1. Pop-up message asks you if you sure you want to log out
2. A cancel button that takes you back to your profile
3. Log out button that takes you back to the login screen

Figma links

- Figma design:
<https://www.figma.com/design/2o459QPq1FggfB1zrhvukq/Untitled?node-id=0-1&t=azDzerzYo0nku3Qf-1>
- Figma prototype:
<https://www.figma.com/proto/2o459QPq1FggfB1zrhvukq/Untitled?node-id=0-1&t=azDzerzYo0nku3Qf-1>